

The Office - 编制预算 (C0173)

The Office - Preparing a Budget (C0173)

对话 / Dialogue

A Welcome Mr and Mrs Carnwell, please take a seat.
欢迎，卡恩韦尔先生、太太，请坐。

B Thank you.
谢谢。

A So I understand that your family spending has sky rocketed and you want to start budgeting.
那么我了解到你们家的开支猛增，想要开始做预算。

C Yes thats correct. Frankly speaking our household income is relatively high and we have never had any money problems, but I think this is the main reason as to why our spending has gone out of control.
是的，没错。坦白说，我们家的收入相对较高，从来没有过什么钱的问题，但我觉得这正是我们开支失控的主要原因。

B We have two kids and with allowances, paying their credit cards, ours and not to mention our mortgage and car payments. With the recent economic downturn, my husband's business has suffered and now we need some advice as to how we can prepare a family budget.
我们有两个孩子，加上给他们的零花钱、还他们的信用卡、我们自己的信用卡，更别提我们的房贷和车贷了。加上最近的经济衰退，我丈夫的生意也受到了影响，现在我们需要一些建议，看看该怎么编制一份家庭预算。

A I see. Well you have come to the right place. First what we need to do, is determine your cash flow. Knowing how much money is coming in will help us allocate spending to different categories such as mortgage, education, groceries, etc.
我明白了。嗯，你们来对地方了。我们首先要做的，是弄清楚你们的现金流。知道有多少钱进账，能帮我们开支分配到不同的类别，比如房贷、教育、日用杂货等等。

B Yes that makes sense.
是的，这有道理。

A Secondly, I need you to bring all of your receipts for the last two to three months. That way, we can determine what your average expenditures are and see which category you are spending money on the most. Usually, your fixed costs are higher and we can't do much about that, but we can usually trim your variable costs such as entertainment or clothing.

其次，我需要你们把过去两到三个月的所有收据都带来。这样，我们就能弄清楚你们的平均支出是多少，看看你们在哪一类上花钱最多。通常，固定成本较高，这方面我们做不了太多，但我们一般可以削减你们的可变开支，比如娱乐或服装。

C Great! We will do that then! Now how about we treat you to a nice dinner?
太好了！那我们就这么做！那么现在，我们请您吃顿丰盛的晚餐怎么样？

A That's another thing. If you really want to stop spending so much money, throw away at least half of your credit cards!

还有一件事。如果你们真想不再花那么多钱，就把你们至少一半的信用卡扔掉吧！

重点词汇 / Key Vocabulary

skyrocket 动词（一般过去时） （如价格）迅速上升、飙升

out of control	短语	超出对某事的掌控能力；失控
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budget	动词（现在进行时）	规划花钱的方式以便存更多钱；做预算
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allocate	动词（原形）	分配
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frankly speaking	短语	坦白说、直说
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补充词汇 / Supplementary Vocabulary

capital	名词（单数）	一个人拥有的金钱或财产形式的财富；资本
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finances	名词（不可数）	个人的财力、财务状况
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to bring in the dough	短语	挣钱
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breadwinner	名词（单数）	收入是家庭主要经济来源的人；养家糊口者
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to itemize	动词	把……逐条列入清单
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